

AUGMENT YOUR WAY TO AWESOMENESS

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #92

The Augmented Sound is pretty cool, and not very hard to understand. All the word "augmented" means is #5. When we see an augmented chord, it's usually a major 7 chord with a #5, or a dominant chord with a #5. Cmaj7 (#5) or C7(#5).

In this video, we aren't talking about waiting for an augmented chord to show up in the chord changes of a song. Here, I'm talking about taking a plain old dominant chord, and adding some extra awesomeness on top, adding the #5. We are talking about adding a little hot sauce, a little extra pepper. Something unexpected.

#1 - Adding the #5 in a "C Blues"

C7 F7 C7 C7

F7 F7 C7 A7

Dm7 G7 C7 Dm7 G7

Here, I am using a simple descending augmented triad (no 7th!), a lick I stole fair and square from Illionis Jacquet, a great tenor sax player.

#2 - A "one measure ii - V - I" lick using the #5

Dm7 G7 Cmaj7

Using the #5 sound, on the dominant V chord.